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UNIVERSITY OF SOUTH CAROLINA

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CSCE 190: Computing in the Modern World

Class 10 – Career and Highlighting for Prof. Success

PROF. BIPLAV SRIVASTAVA, AI INSTITUTE

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Carolinian Creed: "I will practice personal and academic integrity."

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Outline

- Introduction Section
  - Recap from Last Class
- Main Section
  - Highlighting Achievements
  - Elevator Pitch
  - LinkedIn
  - Resume / CV/ Biodata
- Conclusion Section
  - Ask Me Anything



Introduction Section

Recap from Last Lecture - Class 9

We talked about

- Problem Solving Process
- **Validating the Problem**
  - **Creating Requirements and Specifications**
  - **Testing – Concepts and Activities**
- Problem Solving with
  - Computing (Software, Hardware, Services)
  - GenAI
- Selecting Problems that Matter

Assignment 9: Same for All in a Team

- Group 4-5 students
- Discuss a problem category
- Decide on a problem – see ***problems that matter***
- Solve for your problem
  - The group will have one solution plan
  - Add your statement to your GitHub in a sub-folder called ‘assignment-9’
    - Do mention all the students in your group

- Create prompt(s)
  - Record response(s) and iterate, if necessary
- Discuss prompts and responses
  - Verify (with specification, test plans)
  - Validate (with requirements, test plans)
  - Consider both functional specification and non-functional aspects
- Re-think solving strategy
  - LLM choice(s)
  - Prompt strategies
  - Solving approach

See sample testcases at: https://github.com/biplav-s/course-cmw-f26/tree/main/software-dev

Computing in the News

1. **Safe AI for Seniors 2026, system submits false homicide tip to Philadelphia police,** https://www.southcarolinapublicradio.org/sc-news/2026-10-23/usc-hosts-workshop-to-help-older-adults-understand-ai, Oct 2026
   - AI may be child's play with easy access
   - But safety for vulnerable societal segments is a serious issue

2. **Funds**: **Using AI to protect from future bio-threats**, https://news.sky.com/story/uk-pledges-to-spend-600m-to-defend-against-ai-health-and-security-threats-13602935, Oct 2026
   - AI itself is a threat but also a means to improve security
   - Pounds 600m investment

3. **Microsoft offers voluntary buyouts to 60,000 employees as AI leads to efficiency push,** https://www.cnbc.com/2026/10/26/microsoft-msft-voluntary-buyouts.html, Oct 2026
   - More uncertainty due to increasing costs

Main Section

Highlighting Achievements

- Importance
  - If you don't, who will?
  - Helps achieve appropriate recognition and success
- How much
  - Balance - not too much, not too little
  - Magic number – what people remember
    - **Seven** – [**The Magical Number Seven, Plus or Minus Two,** https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Magical_Number_Seven,_Plus_or_Minus_Two]
    - **Three** – in general

Elevator Pitch

- Summarize yourself in 2-minutes
- TL; DR – Too long, didn't read, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/TL;DR
- Question – what to cover
  - What you have done
  - What you want to do
  - Leads to interest in knowing more
- Example –
  - "I have a strong track-record of creating and using AI to solve hard business and societal problems overcoming risks, in individual and leadership capacities."

LinkedIn

- Social media for professional discussion
  - Make connections
  - Hiring and joining
  - Milestone achievements and updates
- Other abilities
  - Write posts
  - Write articles

Resumes (CV/ Biodata)

Distinctions

- Resume: created and used by an individual to present their background, skills, and accomplishments [1]. Usually 1-2 pages, but can be longer
- CV: curriculum vitae – career, qualifications, life. Can be longer than resume and terminology used in old-British influence areas [2]
- Biodata: biographical data, interchangeably with resume. Terminology used in South Asia, and can be for purposes other than career as well

Sources:
1. resume: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/R%C3%A9sum%C3%A9
2. CV: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Curriculum_vitae

USC's Career Center

- Information: https://sc.edu/about/offices_and_divisions/career_center/student_career_hub/index.php
- Review USC Career Center's deck on resume

Assignment 10: Highlight Yourself

- Objectives – *get an internship*
- Means – *have a connection*
- Information – *whom to contact and what to highlight*

- Plan an objective within the next year
- Identify how you may achieve; who can help if contacted
- Identify what information your contact may need
- Record those information
  - Background
  - Skills
  - Accomplishments

See sample testcases at: https://github.com/biplav-s/course-cmw-f26/tree/main/software-dev

Q: One Resume or Multiple ?

- Be flexible based on objective, that may change over time
- Have a master list

Concluding Section

Conclusion

We talked about

- Problem Solving Process
- Validating the Problem
- Selecting Problems that Matter

Week	Content	Assignment
1	Intro, syllabus, university resources	Slack account
2	CSE majors, career paths, research areas	Write a mission statement
3	Github (account and basics) + Lab	Github account, repo
4	HTML basics, IDE (VS Code)	None
5	More HTML, CSS, Problem Solving	Update Github with CSS
6	Brainstorming, problem statement	Problem statement
7	Computing – (Software) Dev. Life Cycle	Draft Requirement, Specification
8	Computing – Testing a System	Test Plan
9	AI – LLMs/FMs, Generative AI, Issues and Challenges	Problem Solving with GenAI
10	Building a resume, LinkedIn	Draft resume in PDF
11	Review resumes	Review resumes, update Github
12	Professionalism and networking	Reconnecting with teachers and mentors
13	CSE research areas	(Finalize website)
N/A	Last day of classes: 4 Dec, 2026	**All extensions end**

Ask Me Anything